

Practice Quiz: Organizational Systems — Module 07: Communication

Name: ____ Date: ____

Part A: Multiple Choice

1. Communication in Active Inference is fundamentally about: A) Sending emails B) Aligning generative models across organizational agents C) Reducing the total number of meetings D) Publishing press releases
2. **Common ground** in organizational communication refers to: A) Shared office space B) Shared assumptions and context that don't need re-establishing in each interaction C) Company-wide email lists D) A common reporting tool
3. Spotify's squad-tribe-chapter-guild structure addresses the model-sharing problem by: A) Reducing the number of employees B) Creating multiple overlapping communication channels that align models at different organizational scales C) Eliminating all meetings D) Centralizing all decisions
4. **Information silos** are best diagnosed as: A) Physical walls between departments B) Organizational agents maintaining local models without cross-boundary communication, causing model divergence C) Insufficient storage space D) Too many communication tools
5. **Signal distortion** up the hierarchy occurs because: A) Executives can't read B) Each level filters, summarizes, and reinterprets, potentially losing nuance and suppressing uncomfortable truths C) Digital communication is unreliable D) There are too many levels
6. A **boundary object** is: A) The physical boundary of a building B) A shared artifact (document, prototype, dashboard) that bridges different specialist models C) A firewall D) An organizational chart

7. Communication overload (too many meetings, too many emails) is problematic because:
- A) It costs money
 - B) Excessive model-alignment attempts consume capacity needed for actual inference and action
 - C) Employees don't like meetings
 - D) It violates company policy
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Part B: Short Analysis

1. Two departments in your company — Engineering and Sales — consistently miscommunicate about product capabilities. Engineering describes technical specifications; Sales describes customer promises. These are different generative models. Design three interventions that would build common ground between these departments.
2. Your organization recently transitioned to remote work. Assess the communication impact: Which formal channels remained effective? Which informal channels were lost? What specific model-alignment mechanisms need to be rebuilt for a distributed workforce?
3. A CEO wants to communicate a major strategic shift to 5,000 employees. The strategy document is 40 pages long. Using Active Inference communication principles, design a multi-channel communication plan that achieves actual model updating (not just information broadcasting) across all organizational levels.